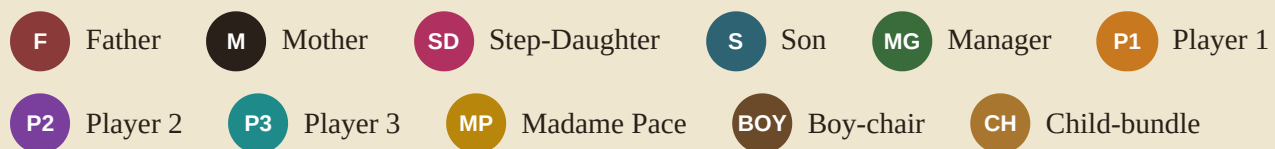


Blocking Storyboard

Every move in the show — the picture and the line it lands on. Six Characters in Search of an Author · Village Players, Lausanne · dir. Kiarash Jamshidi

HOW TO USE IT

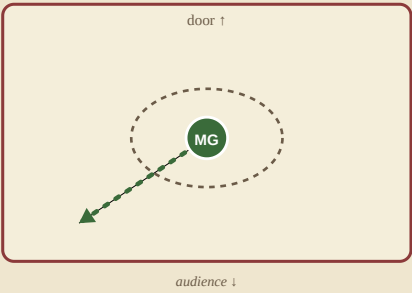
- **One card = one move.** Read the cards top to bottom, in order, act by act and part by part.
- **The picture is the stage seen from above** — the audience sits at the bottom edge (↓). A dashed arrow shows the move; a burst marks a sudden event (a gunshot, the revolver, the veil).
- **The text beside it is the line from the script where the move happens** — the spoken line and its stage direction, nothing added. If there is no move on a card, the position is what matters.
- **The dots are the people; the squares are the two stage objects** (□ the Boy-chair, ◇ the Child-bundle).



Act One — The Family

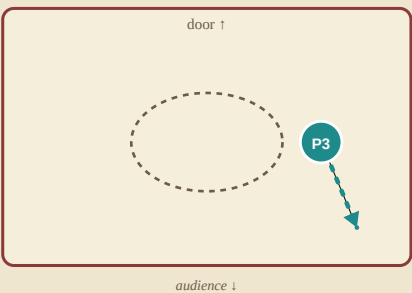
PART I — THE REHEARSAL

1



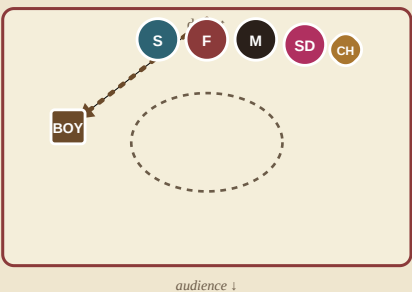
THE MANAGER *[throwing the morning's letter onto the table; he goes to his own chair, set apart].* I can't see a thing in here. *[to Property Man]* A little light, please.

2



PLAYER 3 *[as Prompter].* Pardon, sir — may I get into my box? There's a draught off that door they still haven't mended.

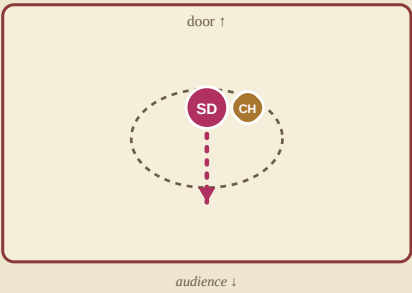
3



[The white working lights soften to amber. The Door-keeper carries on the Boy-chair and sets it at the edge of the stage; the four live Characters — Father, Mother, Step-Daughter, Son — enter, and stop by the door at back; the Step-Daughter already carrying the Child-bundle].

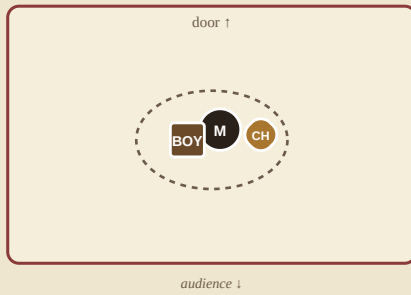
PART II — THE INTERRUPTION

1



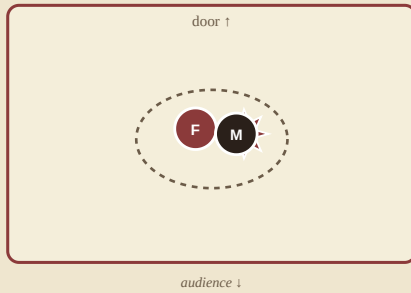
THE STEP-DAUGHTER . With your permission, gentlemen, I, who am a two months' orphan, will show you how well I can dance and sing. *[Sings and dances Prenez garde à Tchou-Tchin-Tchou].*

2



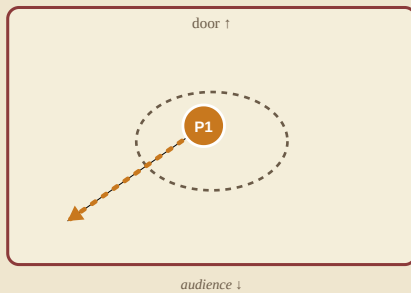
THE MOTHER *[one arm tightens around the Child-bundle, the other goes toward the Boy-chair as if to keep both upright]. In the name of these two little children, I beg you... [She grows faint and is about to fall] Oh God!*

3



THE FATHER *[raising her veil]. Let them see you!*

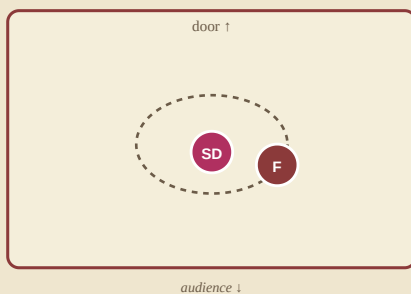
4



PLAYER 1 *[as Leading Man, beginning to relish it — then his eyes reach the Mother, and the rest does not arrive; the company recedes to the wings]. What a spectacle. What an absolute...*

PART III — THE BARGAIN

1

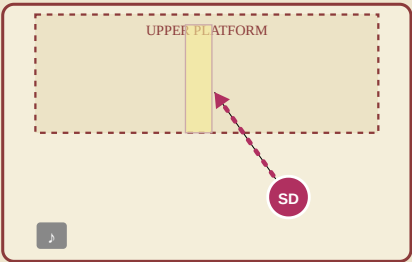


THE STEP-DAUGHTER . The room — I see it. Here is the window with the mantles, the divan, the looking-glass, a screen, and the little mahogany table with the blue envelope and its hundred francs. *[the Father sweats; the light drifts to deep red].*

Act Two — The Theatre

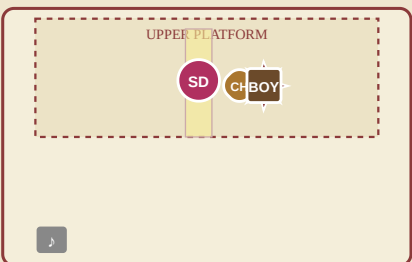
PART I — THE SETUP

1



[The Step-Daughter erupts from the lower floor onto the upper platform with the Child-bundle in her arms and the Boy-chair dragged behind her].

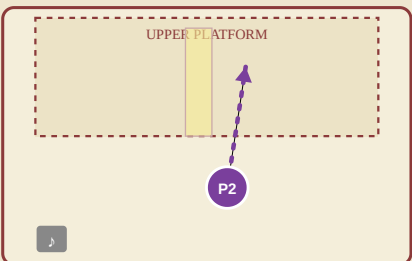
2



THE STEP-DAUGHTER *[alone in the shower light; she turns to the coat on the Boy-chair and takes the revolver from its pocket].*

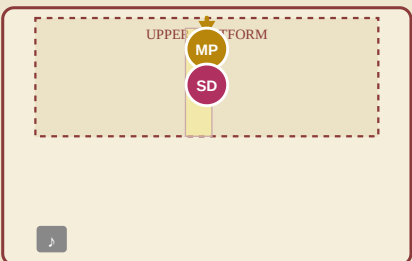
PART II — THE APPARITION

1



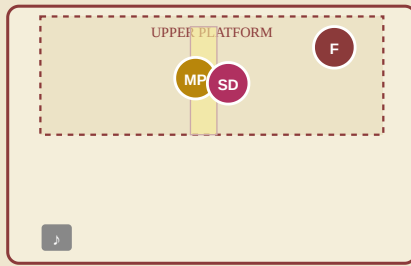
THE FATHER . Would the ladies mind hanging their hats and mantles on the pegs at the back? *[the actresses climb to the platform; the pegs, the shop window, the screen are set].*

2



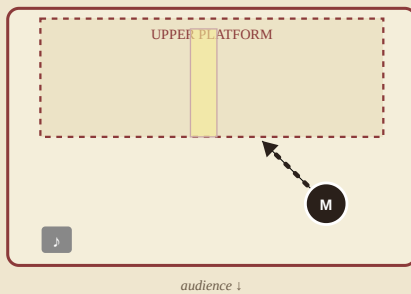
[The door at the back of stage opens and Madame Pace enters and takes a few steps forward].

3



[Madame Pace has placed one hand under the Step-Daughter's chin to raise her head; the Father waits behind the door].

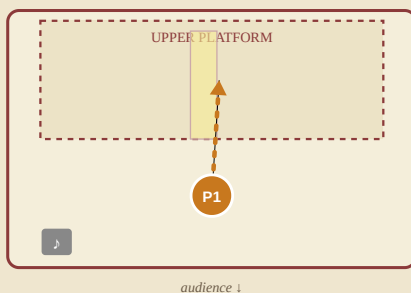
4



THE MOTHER *[from the lower floor, erupting upward].* You old devil! You murderess!

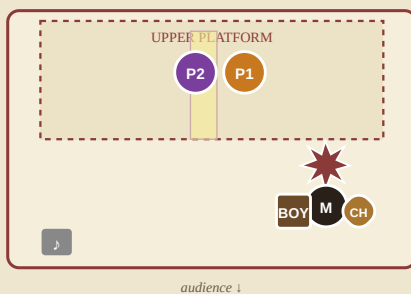
PART III — THE SUBSTITUTION

1



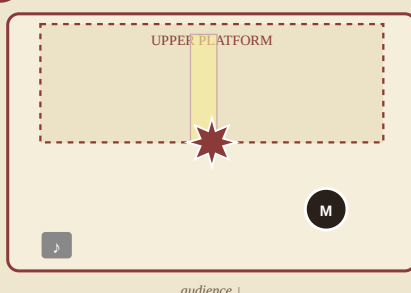
[The door at the back opens and the Leading Man enters with the lively manner of an old gallant; the company replays the shop scene on the platform].

2



THE STEP-DAUGHTER . Cry out, mother. Cry out as you did then!
THE MOTHER *[the shower falls on her on the lower floor].* It's taking place now. It happens all the time.

3

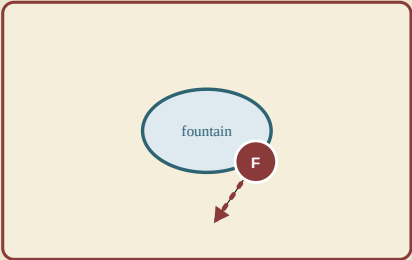


[The Machinist drops the curtain by accident; the act ends not on a line but on the curtain's fall].

Act Three — The Question

PART I — THE TRAP

1

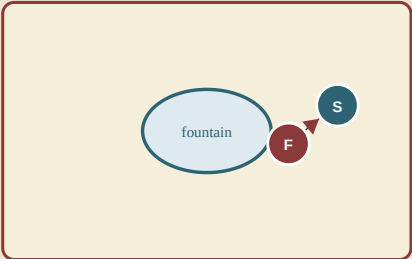


audience ↓

THE FATHER *[turns out toward the house; a pause long enough to feel]*. Can you tell me who you are?

PART II — THE REFUSAL

1



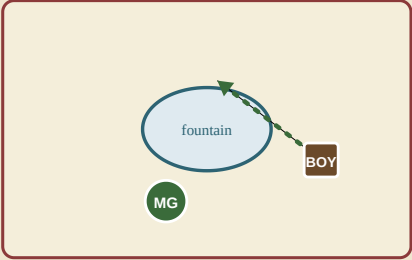
audience ↓

THE FATHER *[not leaving hold of the Son]*. You've got to obey, do you hear?

THE SON *[the body refusing the cry; they separate]*. I won't do it. I won't.

PART III — THE FOUNTAIN

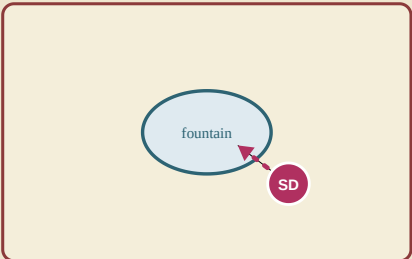
1



audience ↓

THE MANAGER *[he stands; he picks up the Boy-chair himself and walks it across the stage and places it behind the fountain basin]*.

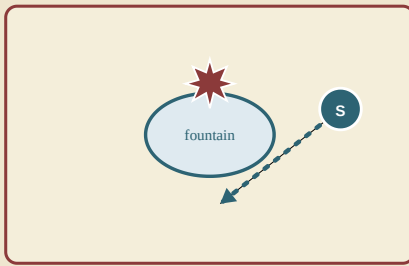
2



audience ↓

[The Step-Daughter bends over the basin and lowers the Child-bundle into it — the basin's walls hide the action].

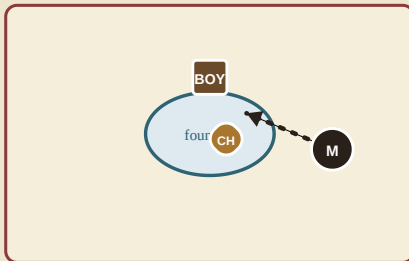
3



audience ↓

THE SON *[his one continuous sentence]. I ran over to her... the boy, standing stock still, watching his little sister in the water. [full blackout; a revolver shot rings out from behind the basin where the Boy-chair is].*

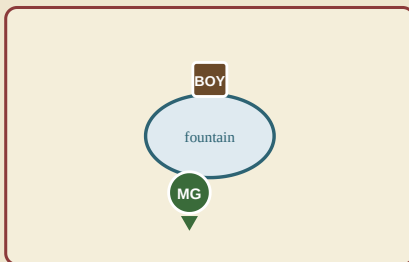
4



audience ↓

THE MOTHER *[she does not cry out at once — she reaches first for the Child-bundle in the basin, then the Boy-chair behind it; her arms cannot hold both, the veil still down]. My son! My son!*

5



audience ↓

THE MANAGER *[a look at the empty Boy-chair; then he turns and leaves the stage the way a man leaves a theatre]. Pretence? Reality? ... To hell with it all.*